

BUDENFINDER

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1. Quantified Problem Statement

Finding an apartment in Berlin is a measurable financial crisis for students and international arrivals. Students pay EUR 1,000–EUR 3,000+ to agents and booking platforms just to secure a room — on top of deposits, rent, and weeks of wasted time across 15+ fragmented portals.

~250	0.3%	EUR 1,000–3,000+	10–20 hrs/week
Applicants per listing	Berlin vacancy rate	Agent fees per placement	Wasted searching

What Students Actually Pay

Cost Category	Estimated Amount
Private agent / relocation fee	EUR 1,000 – EUR 3,000+ (one-time, per placement)
HousingAnywhere booking fee	25–40% of first month's rent (~EUR 175–400)
Spotahome / Uniplaces fee	EUR 150 – EUR 300 per booking
Furnished apartment premium	EUR 200–400/month above unfurnished rate
ImmobilienScout24 subscription	EUR 24.99–39.99/month (tenant-side)
Total upfront burden (student)	EUR 1,500 – EUR 6,000+ before first month

Budenfinder eliminates agent fees entirely — free to search, EUR 4.99/mo for alerts, EUR 9.99/mo for AI auto-apply.

2. Landing Page — Developer Design Structure

Stack: Next.js 16 (App Router) · Tailwind CSS · Framer Motion · Mapbox GL JS · NextAuth.js v5

Section	Specification
Section 1 — Hero	Full-viewport. Headline: 'Every Rental in Berlin. 1 Intelligence Feed. 1-Click Apply.' Animated Berlin map with listing pins. Primary CTA: 'Start Searching for Free'. Sticky navbar.
Section 2 — Problem	Dark navy background. Stat cards: 250 applicants/listing · EUR 1,000–3,000 agent fees · 10–20 hrs/week wasted. Framer Motion fade-in on scroll.
Section 3 — How It Works	6-step numbered flow: Sign Up · Profile · Feed · Alerts · AI Apply · Track. Horizontal stepper (desktop), vertical accordion (mobile).
Section 4 — Features	2-column problem/solution cards. 8 cards covering portals, language, paperwork, fraud, Mietpreisbremse, agent fees.
Section 5 — Pricing	3-tier cards: Free (EUR 0) · Mid (EUR 4.99/mo) · Pro (EUR 9.99/mo) · Pro+ (EUR 14.99/mo). Monthly/annual toggle.
Section 6 — Comparison	Table: Budenfinder vs. ImmobilienScout24. Green ticks vs. red X. Budenfinder column highlighted.
Section 7 — Social Proof	3 persona cards: Expat Student · Working Professional · International Expat. University partner logos.
Section 8 — Footer	Final CTA banner. Links: About, Pricing, Blog (SEO), Legal (DSGVO). Social icons.

3. Development Task Board

Task	Summary
Task 1	SSO Login + Onboarding Questionnaire Engineer 1 Sprint 1
Task 2	Apartment Search via Web Scraping Engineer 2 Sprint 1
Task 3	Private Company Partnerships (Circus Living, Central Point) Biz Dev Sprint 2
Task 4	Social Media Campaign + Student Form Marketing Sprint 2
Task 5	SEO Infrastructure + Content Strategy Engineer 1 + Marketing Sprint 2-3

TASK 1 — SSO Login + Onboarding Questionnaire			
Owner: Engineer 1 (Frontend)	Priority: P0 — Critical	Sprint: Sprint 1 (Week 1-2)	Status: To Do

Description

Build Google OAuth (NextAuth.js v5) + email/password login. On first login, route new users through a 5-step onboarding questionnaire capturing budget, location, apartment type, lifestyle, and move-in date. Data feeds the AI matching engine.

Steps / Subtasks

- Set up NextAuth.js v5 with Google OAuth + email/password provider
- Create /login and /signup pages with DSGVO consent checkbox
- Detect new users on first login → redirect to /onboarding
- Build 5-step onboarding form: Budget · Location · Apartment type · Lifestyle · Profile
- Save profile to PostgreSQL via POST /api/profile/onboarding
- On completion → redirect to /dashboard (personalised feed)
- Allow 'Skip for now' on each step — partial profiles still get a feed
- DSGVO: user can delete account + all data from /settings

Acceptance Criteria

- Google SSO login completes and creates a DB user record
- New users are automatically routed to /onboarding after first login
- Onboarding saves partial progress — user can return and continue
- DSGVO consent is recorded with timestamp
- All auth routes redirect unauthenticated users to /login

TASK 2 — Apartment Search via Web Scraping			
Owner: Engineer 2 (Backend)	Priority: P0 — Critical	Sprint: Sprint 1 (Week 1-2)	Status: To Do

Description

Build a scraping backend that aggregates listings from all major Berlin portals into one normalised DB. Runs on a schedule, deduplicates, detects fraud, checks Mietpreisbremse compliance, and serves listings via REST API.

Steps / Subtasks

- Set up separate Node.js/Python scraping service (deploy on Railway or Fly.io)
- Build adapters for: WG-Gesucht, ImmobilienScout24, Immowelt, eBay Kleinanzeigen, Wunderflats, HousingAnywhere, Spotahome
- Normalise all listings: title, price (warm/cold), size (m²), district, URL, source, date, images, description
- Deduplication: hash title + price + district + size — skip if exists
- Schedule with BullMQ (Redis): run every 2 hours per portal
- Polite scraping: randomised delays (2–8s), rotating user agents, proxy rotation
- Fraud detection: flag listings >40% below market, wire transfer requests, duplicate images
- Mietpreisbremse checker: flag listings above EUR 15.79/m² Berlin average
- Build GET /api/listings (paginated, filtered, AI-ranked) and GET /api/listings/:id
- Mark listings inactive if not seen in 48 hours

Acceptance Criteria

- Scraper extracts listings from at least 5 of 7 target portals
 - All listings normalised to unified schema with no missing required fields
 - Deduplication removes 100% of exact duplicates across portals
 - Fraud-flagged listings excluded from default feed
 - Mietpreisbremse violations flagged on listing detail page
 - API returns results in <500ms (with Redis caching)
 - Scraper runs 72 hours in staging without manual intervention
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TASK 3 — Private Company Partnerships — Circus Living, Central Point & Others

Owner: Business Development + Engineer 2 (API)	Priority: P1 — High	Sprint: Sprint 2 (Week 3–4)	Status: To Do
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Description

Establish direct affiliate agreements with private student housing companies in Berlin — starting with Circus Living and Central Point Living — to list verified inventory on Budenfinder and earn 10–15% referral commission per student placement.

Steps / Subtasks

- Research Circus Living and Central Point Living: properties, pricing, capacity, booking model
- Expand shortlist to 10–15 partners: The Fizz, Berlinovo, Youniq, Milestone, Quarters, Habyt, HousingAnywhere, Spotahome
- Draft 2-page Partnership Proposal: Budenfinder overview, 200,000 Berlin students, commission model, DSGVO compliance
- Outreach via email + LinkedIn — schedule 5–8 meetings within 2 weeks
- Negotiate: 10–15% of first month's rent or booking fee per student placed
- Sign Affiliate Agreement: 12-month rolling, non-exclusive, 30-day payment terms
- Engineer 2: build 'Verified Partner' badge in listings API (is_verified_partner: true)
- Engineer 2: build partner tracking links (UTM) and monthly commission report endpoint
- Add WBS eligibility flag on partner listings for subsidy-eligible students

Acceptance Criteria

- At least 3 signed affiliate agreements by end of Sprint 2
- Circus Living and/or Central Point listings appear with 'Verified Partner' badge
- Partner tracking links correctly attribute student transactions
- Monthly commission report generated automatically
- WBS eligibility flag appears on all eligible partner listings

TASK 4 — Social Media Campaign + Student Intake Form

Owner: Marketing + Engineer 1 (form build)	Priority: P1 — High	Sprint: Sprint 2 (Week 3–4)	Status: To Do
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Description

Launch a targeted campaign across Berlin student Facebook groups, Instagram, and LinkedIn. Centre the campaign on a student intake form that captures leads and feeds them into the onboarding funnel.

Steps / Subtasks

- Identify and join 10+ Berlin student Facebook groups (WG Berlin, CODE Community, BSBI Students, HU/FU/TU International, expat groups)
- Create 4-week content calendar: 3 posts/week per platform (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn)
- Post types: problem-awareness (agent fee stats), solution, testimonial, form CTA
- Engineer 1: build /student-form (no login required) — fields: Name, Email, University, Move-in date, Budget, How did you hear about us?
- On submit: save to leads table + trigger welcome email via Resend API

- Form embeddable as iframe for Facebook group posts
- Schedule posts via Buffer/Later for Instagram + LinkedIn; manual for Facebook groups
- Run paid Instagram/Facebook ad: EUR 200 budget, ages 18–35, interests: Berlin, student life, apartment search
- Track: form submissions per channel (UTM params), cost per lead, conversion to signup

Acceptance Criteria

- Student intake form live at /student-form, accepts submissions without login
 - Form submissions saved to DB and trigger welcome email within 60 seconds
 - Content calendar covers 4 weeks across all 3 platforms
 - At least 10 Berlin student Facebook groups identified and first posts published
 - Paid ad live with correct audience targeting and UTM tracking
 - Target: 200+ form submissions in first 2 weeks
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TASK 5 — SEO Infrastructure + Content Strategy

Owner: Engineer 1 + Marketing	Priority: P1 — High	Sprint: Sprint 2–3 (Week 3–6)	Status: To Do
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Description

Build technical SEO foundations and launch content targeting high-intent Berlin rental queries. Target: 10,000 organic visits/month by Year 1 (Lean Canvas Go-To-Market channel).

Steps / Subtasks

- Engineer 1: implement Next.js Metadata API — unique title + meta description per page
- Engineer 1: add JSON-LD structured data (Organization, WebSite, FAQPage) to homepage
- Engineer 1: generate dynamic sitemap.xml and robots.txt; submit to Google Search Console
- Engineer 1: add Open Graph + Twitter Card meta tags on all pages
- Engineer 1: ensure Core Web Vitals pass — LCP <2.5s, FID <100ms, CLS <0.1
- Engineer 1: implement hreflang tags for EN/DE language versions
- Engineer 1: set up Google Analytics 4 + Google Tag Manager — track CTA clicks and signup conversions
- Marketing: produce 8 SEO blog posts targeting: 'apartments Berlin students', 'Mietpreisbremse Berlin', 'Berlin rental guide expats', 'cheap apartments Berlin 2026', 'SCHUFA for students Berlin'
- Marketing: build /neighbourhood-guide (12 Berlin districts, rent data, vibe score)
- Marketing: build /mietpreisbremse-guide (plain-English rent cap explainer + Budenfinder CTA)

Acceptance Criteria

- All pages have unique, keyword-optimised title tags and meta descriptions
- Sitemap submitted to Google Search Console; all pages indexed within 2 weeks
- Homepage passes Core Web Vitals on mobile (Lighthouse >90)
- 8 blog posts published and indexed
- Google Analytics 4 tracks signup conversions with correct event names
- Target: 500+ organic visits/month within 60 days of launch

4. Team Allocation & Sprint Plan

Team Member	Responsibilities
Engineer 1 (Frontend)	Task 1: SSO + Onboarding Task 4: Form build Task 5: Technical SEO
Engineer 2 (Backend)	Task 2: Web Scraping Engine Task 3: Partner API integration
Business Development	Task 3: Partnership outreach — Circus Living, Central Point, others
Marketing	Task 4: Social media campaign + content calendar Task 5: Content production

Sprint	Focus
Sprint 1 — Week 1–2	Task 1 (SSO + Onboarding) Task 2 (Scraping Engine MVP)
Sprint 2 — Week 3–4	Task 3 (Partnerships) Task 4 (Social Campaign) Task 5 (SEO setup)
Sprint 3 — Week 5–6	Task 5 (Content production) Bug fixes Staging QA
Sprint 4 — Week 7–8	Production launch Partner integrations live Analytics review

Definition of Done (All Tasks)

- Code reviewed and merged to main via pull request
- Feature tested on Vercel staging preview URL
- All acceptance criteria checked off
- No P0 or P1 bugs open against the feature
- DSGVO compliance reviewed for any feature handling personal data
- Analytics events firing correctly in Google Tag Manager

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